INNOVATION LABS 2027

PARTNER BRIEF · 2027

Co-builders, not logo sponsors. Shape 2027 with us.

Innovation Labs is a privately funded pre-accelerator; partnerships keep it free for students and independent of public-sector agendas. In 2027 we run a smaller, better-resourced cohort and extend support past Demo Day into an investment track.

THE 2026 EDITION

221
teams applied from 16 cities; 41 entered the program

~53h
mentoring per team, ~2,200 hours donated

144
companies across 29 mentor sessions

12/20
partners with us four years or more

Source: IL26 report and mentor retro, 7 July 2026.

WHAT PARTNERS BRING

- **Mentor and decision-maker networks** with specialised domain knowledge
- **Anonymised data** teams can use to train models
- **Cloud and hardware credits**
- **Corporate client bases** for B2B2B and B2B2C validation
- **A long-run commitment**, not a single event-day appearance

WHAT CHANGES IN 2027

Themed tracks with a main partner

PPC Romania joins with an Energy track and Open Challenges co-defined from its business-unit needs.

Open Challenges, readiness-gated

A challenge runs only when the partner brings an internal owner, usable data and a real budget.

Always-on presence through AILabsRO

Year-round visibility, branded scholarships, partner-led modules and early access to a national talent pool.

THE 2027 JOURNEY · DATES ESTIMATED

OCT 2026 – FEB
Pre-program
Partner alignment and recruitment events

~20–21 MAR
Hackathon
About 40 teams enter the program

MAR – APR
Bootcamps
Cohort cut a week after Bootcamp 2

APR – ~24 MAY
Demo Day
Boost Days, semifinals, final

FROM JUNE
IL Beyond
Post-program track toward investment

NEW · IL BEYOND

From finalist to fundable.

For graduates and alumni of any edition, aimed at a EUR 300k–500k pre-seed round. The EGV Investment Prize moves here, alongside our EUR 20,000 angel bridge.

6
S1 · Build
Jul–Sep · PMF and moat

3–4
S2 · Sell
Oct–Dec · incorporate, sell

2
S3 · Raise
Jan–Feb · term sheet to cash

Co-define a track, mentor hands-on, host a bootcamp or co-invest through IL Beyond.
Partner alignment runs October 2026 – February 2027.

linktr.ee/InnovationLabs
2027 dates, cohort sizes and IL Beyond details are proposals and may change.